

THIS ISSUE TRAINS · BUILDING THINGS THAT RUN WITHOUT YOU

Money and markets

Cash quietly became interesting again. With US interest rates at 3.50 to 3.75 percent after the Federal Reserve's cuts through late 2025, money market funds, which hold ultra safe short term debt, kept paying savers a real return simply for parking cash.

Commentators noted that waiting in such funds has genuinely paid off. No picking winners, no timing, no drama: just a rate working on a balance every single day, weekends included.

The SCD takeaway: returns you never have to manage are the cheapest returns there are. Count them before chasing exciting ones.

Sources: USAGOLD 2025 policy review; Bloomberg Markets commentary.

Engineering corner

Paint that cools a building with zero power. Passive radiative cooling materials, now sold as paints, films and roof tiles, keep surfaces below air temperature using no electricity: they radiate heat at infrared wavelengths that pass straight through the atmosphere into space, day and night, with no moving parts and no bill.

The SCD takeaway: the best machine is often the one with no moving parts and no bill.

Source: World Economic Forum, Top 10 Emerging Technologies of 2026.

Your move

The most underrated systems keep producing after you stop pushing: interest compounding, a coating radiating heat away, a habit on autopilot. Active effort stops when you do.

This week, on your own: set up one thing that keeps paying you back without attention: an automatic saving transfer, a flashcard deck, a recurring reminder. Then leave it alone and let it run.